

## SHEENA VAGHELA

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### EDUCATION

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**The University of Texas at Austin**, School of Computing (3.79 / 4.00)

*Master of Science in Information Studies (Human Computer Interaction)*

May 2028

*Bachelor of Science in Informatics, Bridging Disciplines Program Design Strategies Certificate*

May 2027

**Garland High School**, Garland, TX

2019 - 2023

### EXPERIENCE

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**Texas Advanced Computing Center** - UX Design & Research Assistant

Jun. 2026 - Present

- Designed an educational initiative that gamifies high-performance computing concepts through interactive, restaurant-themed simulations
- Authored a user study protocol and conducted user interviews to validate design intent and usability, using mixed-methods research to measure educational impact and technical robustness across diverse user demographics

**Texas Momentum** - UX Designer ([Tacite.ai](https://tacite.ai))

Feb. 2026 - Apr. 2026

- Synthesized customer discovery interviews to define users, validate pain points, and inform product strategy
- Translated research insights into feature recommendations and roadmap decisions for an early-stage AI startup
- Identified usability issues and product bugs through hands-on usability testing, delivering UX/UI improvements

**Longhorn Developers** - UX Designer

Feb. 2025 - Present

- Designing an upcoming mobile app for Sure Walk, iterating on ride-request and safety workflows for 20,000+ students through multiple rounds of usability testing
- Conducted user interviews and cohort analysis to identify friction points and validate design decisions
- Redesigned onboarding and core UI flows based on research findings to improve task efficiency and user experience

**Texas Convergent** - UX Design Lead

Jan. 2024 - Present

- Conducted UX research for a mobile app integrated with the Longhorn Life Sciences medical device, interviewing nurses to map clinical workflows, identify pain points, and guide design decisions
- Designed the MVP of HerdUp, a student organization discovery platform that streamlines how students connect with campus communities, grounded in user research and accessibility
- Designed and pitched an AI research summarization tool translating academic workflows into a product concept

**iRISE Program** - Undergraduate Researcher

Aug. 2025 - May 2026

- Conducted mixed-methods research on how geopolitical narratives influence user perceptions of digital platforms
- Analyzed qualitative data to identify behavioral and trust-related patterns in user adoption
- Synthesized insights and presented UX-centered recommendations to faculty and research teams

**Develop For Good** - Product Designer for SBEE Digital

Jul. 2025 - Aug. 2025

- Designed multi-platform user experiences for electricity application workflows in Benin for low-literacy users
- Built personas, journey maps, and end-to-end user flows for applicants, agents, and supervisors
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to translate service problems into scalable solutions impacting 6M+ users

**Texas Cybersecurity Clinic** - Cybersecurity Consultant

Jan. 2026 - Apr. 2026

- Evaluated cybersecurity policies and system workflows for usability and operational risk gaps
- Translated technical constraints into actionable recommendations for non-technical stakeholders
- Collaborated with teams to prioritize improvements balancing security and usability

### HONORS & AWARDS

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● **Texas Convergent Demo Day Pitch Competition (1st Place)** - Built an AI research summarizer

May 2024

● **Design @UT's Annual Design-a-thon** - Excellence in Innovation Award

Nov. 2025

### ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

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**Tools:** Figma, Framer, Adobe Illustrator, Miro, Jira, Linear, Python

**Skills:** Usability Testing, User Interviews, Surveys, Heuristic Evaluation, Card Sorting, Personas, Journey Mapping, User Flows, Wireframing, Prototyping, Information Architecture, Design Systems, Accessibility

**Student Organizations:** Texas Convergent, Longhorn Developers, Texas Royals, Camp Kesem

**Interests:** Hiking, Sketching, Tennis, Traveling, Running